ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 7

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 3 · WRITING · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 60

Marking guideline for the Academic Central Grade 7 English First Additional Language paper 3 · writing.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 7. It is not a Department of Basic Education marking guideline.

How to mark: Writing is marked with the rubrics below, not with ticks. Read the whole piece first, then decide on the level for each criterion. Learners may interpret topics in their own way as long as the writing is relevant.

SECTION A: ESSAY – RUBRIC (30 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content and planning (18)	15–18: Original, interesting ideas; fully on topic; vivid detail; strong opening and ending	11–14: Relevant, well-developed ideas; good detail	8–10: Mostly relevant; some detail; ideas sometimes ordinary	5–7: Ideas thin or repeated; parts not on topic	0–4: Hardly on topic; very few ideas
Language, style and editing (9)	8–9: Varied vocabulary and sentences; very few errors	6–7: Good vocabulary; few errors	5: Simple but clear; some errors	3–4: Limited vocabulary; many errors make reading hard	0–2: Errors make the meaning unclear
Structure (3)	3: Clear paragraphs; ideas flow logically; correct length	2: Paragraphs mostly used; some ideas out of order		0–1: No paragraphs; disorganised; far too short or long	

1.1 **The day I got lost** – a clear story with a beginning (where and why), a problem (getting lost, feelings of fear), a climax and a resolution (how the learner was found or found the way). Past tense used consistently. [30]

1.2 **My favourite place** – description, not a story. Look for sense details (sight, sound, smell, touch, taste), adjectives and figures of speech (similes, metaphors), and a reason why the place is special. [30]

1.3 **The best gift I ever received** – a story explaining the gift, who gave it, the occasion and why it matters. Credit learners who choose a non-material gift (e.g. a lesson, a friendship, a second chance). [30]

1.4 The story MUST end with the given words. The events must lead logically to the ending, e.g. a scam, a cruel joke, a virus or a dangerous meeting. Deduct from Content if the ending is missing or does not fit. [30]

1.5 Opinion clearly stated in the introduction; at least THREE reasons, each in its own paragraph with an example (e.g. safety, research, emergencies / distraction, theft, cyberbullying); a conclusion that restates the opinion. [30]

TOTAL SECTION A: [30]

SECTION B: LONGER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT – RUBRIC (20 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content, planning and format (12)	10–12: All requirements of the task covered; correct format throughout; suitable register (tone)	8–9: Most requirements; format mostly correct	6–7: Some requirements; format partly correct	4–5: Few requirements; format mostly wrong	0–3: Task not understood; no format
Language, style and editing (8)	7–8: Very few errors; suitable vocabulary	5–6: Few errors	4: Some errors; meaning clear	2–3: Many errors	0–1: Meaning unclear

2.1 **Friendly letter** – Format: writer's address top right; date below it; greeting ("Dear …,"); body in paragraphs; ending ("Your cousin,"/"Love,"); first name. Content: holiday plans with details AND an invitation with dates. Register: informal, friendly. [20]

2.2 **Formal letter** – Format: writer's address top right with date; recipient's address on the left ("The Municipal Manager, … Municipality …"); "Dear Sir/Madam"; subject line (e.g. "RE: DANGEROUS POTHOLE IN … STREET"); body; "Yours faithfully"; signature and full name. Content: where the pothole is, the accident, why it is dangerous, a clear request. Register: formal and polite, no slang or contractions. [20]

2.3 **Dialogue** – Format: names on the left followed by a colon; no quotation marks; stage directions (if any) in brackets; a short line setting the scene is acceptable. Content: date, food and music all discussed; natural, believable conversation; a clear ending (decision). [20]

TOTAL SECTION B: [20]

SECTION C: SHORTER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT – RUBRIC (10 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content, planning and format (6)	6: All information; correct, attractive format	5: Most information; format correct	4: Some information missing	2–3: Much missing; poor format	0–1: Task not understood
Language, style and editing (4)	4: Almost no errors	3: Few errors	2: Some errors		0–1: Many errors

3.1 **Invitation** – who is invited; occasion (13th birthday); date, time (start and end), place (address); RSVP with a contact name/number and date; any extra information (e.g. dress code, bring a swimming costume). [10]

3.2 **Poster** – eye-catching heading; what (cake sale), why (sports equipment), when, where, prices or a list of items; short phrases rather than long sentences; layout that attracts attention. [10]

3.3 **Diary entry** – date (and day) at the top; "Dear Diary" (optional); first person, past tense; events of the day in order; feelings and reflection; informal, personal tone. [10]

TOTAL SECTION C: [10]

TOTAL: 60

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE